**READING UNIT 6 – GS**

# What is a Code Editor?

A code editor is one of the most essential tools for any software developer. At its core, a code editor is a program designed to help developers write, read, and modify source code more easily. While basic editors like Notepad can technically be used to write programs, professional developers usually prefer more advanced editors because they offer features that save time and reduce mistakes. These features include syntax highlighting, automatic indentation, and real-time suggestions.

Many code editors today, such as Visual Studio Code or Sublime Text, provide much more than a simple writing environment. They include smart tools that detect errors as soon as they appear, highlight suspicious code, or even suggest a fix before the developer notices the problem. This immediate feedback is especially useful for beginners, whose eyes often widen when they see the editor correcting their code automatically. In addition, most modern editors allow extensions or plug-ins that add extra functions, such as connecting directly to a database, checking grammar in comments, or integrating with version-control systems like Git.

Some code editors also include panels that act like windows into different parts of the project. One window might show all the files in the workspace, another might display the output of the program, while another shows the messages from the compiler. These tools make the coding experience more organized and intuitive. Instead of switching between different apps, developers can access everything from one place.

Although code editors are not as complete as a full Integrated Development Environment (IDE), they have grown increasingly powerful. Their lightweight design and fast speed make them popular not only among professionals, but also among students learning programming for the first time. And thanks to plug-ins, a simple editor can quickly transform into a highly customized development environment.

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**1. Read the text and answer these questions**:

**a.** What is the main purpose of a code editor?
**b.** Why do professional developers prefer advanced editors?
**c.** Which tools make beginners "open their eyes wide"?
**d.** What kinds of windows or panels can be found in some editors?
**e.** Why are code editors popular among students?

**2. Are the statements true or false? Justify your answer.**

**a.** A basic text editor includes syntax highlighting and intelligent suggestions.
**b.** Modern code editors can detect errors in real time.
**c.** Plug-ins cannot add new features to a code editor.
**d.** Some windows inside the editor show the project's file structure.
**e.** Code editors are usually slower and heavier than IDEs.

**3. Complete the sentences:**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| SYNTAX | SUGGESTIONS | BEGINNERS |
| PLUG-INS | ERRORS | CUSTOMIZE |
| LIGHTWEIGHT | HIGHLIGHT | |
| WORKSPACE | PANELS | |

1. Modern code editors can detect _____ as soon as they appear in the code.
2. Features like _____ highlighting help developers read code more easily.
3. Many editors allow _____ that add new tools or functions.
4. Some windows inside a code editor show all the files in the _____
5. Real-time _____ often surprise and help _____ who are learning to program.
6. Code editors are popular because they are fast and _____
7. Developers can _____ their editor by installing extensions.
8. Different _____ inside the editor display output, messages, and file lists.